STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-6400

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED **12/04/06**	DATE REVISED	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE	RESOURCES
GENERAL	

SUBJECT	CROSS REFERENCE
CUSTODIAL DEATH PREVENTION	G-6300 AUTHORIZED RESTRAINTS P-3230 IN-CAR AUDIO/VIDEO RECORDING SYSTEM

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the prevention of custodial deaths.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office employees must use extreme care and caution when encountering individuals who exhibit signs or behaviors which would indicate a high potential for "sudden custody death syndrome." Individuals at risk for "sudden custody death syndrome" shall be monitored closely and provided medical treatment as soon as possible.

III. Definitions:

A. SUDDEN CUSTODY DEATH SYNDROME: For purposes of this policy, sudden custody death syndrome shall be considered the unintentional death of a subject while in law enforcement custody. This category of deaths which has no apparent detectable anatomical cause occurs while or shortly after a subject is taken into custody.

B. RESTRAINT STRESS: The unexpected respiratory failure of a subject as a result of physical exhaustion while being restrained.

C. EXCITED DELIRIUM: An acute mental disorder characterized by distorted thinking, disorientation, and hallucinations. A subject displaying excited delirium symptoms is considered in need of immediate medical attention.

D. SUBSTANCE INDUCED EXCITED DELIRIUM/CHEMICAL PYSCHOSIS: Excited delirium caused by the ingestion or exposure to a chemical substances (e.g. cocaine, methamphetamines, PCP, THC, LSD, alcohol, etc.).

E. **POSITIONAL ASPHYXIA:** Occurs when the position of the body interferes with respiration resulting in asphyxia. Contributing factors include airway obstructions, the subject's inability to change position, and respiratory muscle fatigue. Positional asphyxia is related to the following:

1. Confined spaces.
2. Hogtying.
3. Obesity.
4. Restraint stress.
5. Alcohol or drug use.
6. Excited delirium.

F. **HOGTIE:** The connecting of an individual's restrained hands with his or her feet behind the back using a restraint less than 12" in length.

IV. Procedures:

A. Sudden Custody Death Syndrome Symptoms:

1. Behavior Symptoms:

a) Violent and combative resistance.
b) Extreme strength.
c) Paranoia.
d) Self-inflicted injuries.
e) Purposeless running.
f) Hallucinations and/or illusions.
g) Seizures
h) Aggression toward objects-particularly glass.
i) Undressing in public due to hyperthermia.
j) Hiding behind objects (e.g. bushes, cars, etc.).
k) Thrashing after restraint.
l) Shouting.
m) Hearing voices.
n) Talking incoherently.
o) Combative to tranquil-this should be deemed a medical emergency.

2. Physical Symptoms:

a) Profuse sweating.
b) Dilated pupils.
c) High blood pressure.
d) Hyperthermia 104-108 degrees.
e) Inability to breath-gasping.
f) Uncontrolled shaking.

g) Skin tone and coloration (pale or red).
h) Foaming at the mouth.

B. **Employee Responsibilities:** When faced with a subject who displays multiple listed symptoms, the employee shall consider the situation a medical emergency and should attempt the following:

1. The employee should summon emergency medical personnel. If the situation is not yet under control, the emergency medical personnel can be requested to stand by at a nearby location.

2. Use only objectively reasonable force to restrain the individual and attempt to limit the duration of the confrontation, when feasible. Prolonged exertion may heighten the chance of sudden death.

3. The employee should attempt to calm the subject.

4. Once the individual is restrained using authorized restraints (see G-6300 Authorized Restraints), the subject should be placed on his or her side or in a seated position with his or her back resting against a fixed object, when tactically safe. Subjects should not be placed in a prone position.

5. The subject should be closely monitored for voluntary breathing, movement, color, speech, sweating, and foaming at the mouth. The employee should also check for a “Medical Alert” bracelet or necklace. If the subject changes from extremely violent to tranquil, emergency medical personnel should be summoned immediately.

6. If required, the subject’s feet may be secured with authorized restraints and in accordance with proper training. The subject shall not be hogtied and shall not be placed in a prone position.

7. If after the employee’s assessment of the subject, he or she continues to display symptoms indicating sudden custody death syndrome, the employee shall:

a) Inform the medical personnel of the assessment.
b) Arrange for the subject to be transported to the nearest medical facility.
c) After arranging for medical treatment, the employee shall ensure his or her supervisor is notified.
d) The supervisor shall notify the on-duty watch commander or the ADC.

C. **Transportation of a Subject:** It is recommended that transportation of a subject displaying symptoms of sudden custody death syndrome be completed by

emergency medical personnel (i.e. ambulance). If a subject must be transported by deputies, the following procedures shall be followed:

1. Two deputies shall transport any subject displaying the described symptoms to the nearest medical facility.

2. The second deputy shall closely monitor the subject for the described symptoms during the duration of the transportation.

3. During hours of darkness, the interior vehicle lights should be utilized.

4. If equipped, the in-car video recording system shall be activated with the camera focused on the subject (see P-3230 In-Car Audio/Video Recording System).

D. **Reporting Requirements:** All employees involved with a subject displaying symptoms of sudden custody death syndrome, as described in this policy, shall submit a complete and accurate supplemental report regarding the incident prior to the end of the shift. Reports shall be extremely detailed. The supplemental reports shall be in addition to any required offense report or Use of Force Report form and shall include:

1. The employee's actions during the incident including all levels of force attempted and the type and use of restraints.

2. The employee's observations and assessment of the subject.

3. The time when emergency medical personnel were summoned and the time of their arrival.

4. The employee's actions while waiting for medical personnel.

5. The information provided by the employee to the medical personnel upon their arrival regarding the assessment of the subject's condition.

6. A description of transportation procedures utilized.